Welcome to Folio

A short guide to your new reader

Your PDFs, read like books.

CHAPTER 1

Reading

Folio turns pages sideways, like a paper book.

Turn the page
Swipe left or right, or tap the right or left edge of the screen. A quick flick is enough.

Zoom
Pinch, or double-tap the spot you want to see closer. Double-tap again to zoom back out. The zoom stays on as you turn pages, so you can read a whole book zoomed in.

Show the menus
Tap the middle of the page. They tuck themselves away when you turn a page.

Jump anywhere
Drag the slider at the bottom, or tap the page number to type one. After a jump, Back to page takes you back.

Folio remembers your page in every book and reopens right where you stopped.

CHAPTER 2

Find your way

Three buttons at the top right of every book.

The ribbon
Bookmarks the page you are on. Tap it again to remove the bookmark.

The list
Opens the contents, your bookmarks, and search. This guide has chapters, so try jumping to one from the contents.

Aa
Display settings: light, sepia and dark themes, one page or two side by side, and zoom.

On a tablet, turn the screen sideways to see two pages at once, like an open book.

CHAPTER 3

Your library

Everything you add stays on this device and works offline.

Add books

Tap + to pick PDFs from Files, Drive or Downloads. On Android you can also share a PDF straight to Folio, and on a computer you can drag PDFs onto the window.

Albums

Folio reads each new PDF, on this device only, and works out the title, the author and what kind of book it is. It then suggests an album, such as Fiction or Textbooks. Check the guess and tap to file it.

Tidy up

Each book has a … menu to rename it, move it to another album or remove it. Select lets you move several books at once.

CHAPTER 4

Keep a backup

Your books never leave this device, so keep a copy of your setup.

Back up

In the library, open Settings and tap Back up. It saves your albums, bookmarks and reading positions to a small file.

Restore

On a new device, tap Restore, then add the same PDFs. Everything attaches to them again.

Your PDFs

The backup holds your setup, not the books themselves, so keep the PDFs in Files, Drive or Downloads too. Uninstalling Folio removes the copies inside it.

CHAPTER 5

Where to find books

Folio opens PDFs you already have. These sites offer books you can download legally and free.

Project Gutenberg
gutenberg.org. Over 70,000 classics whose copyright has expired.

OpenStax
openstax.org. Free college textbooks as PDFs.

Internet Archive
archive.org. Its public-domain collections.

arXiv
arxiv.org. Research papers in science and maths.

Books bought from Kindle or Apple Books are copy-protected, so they cannot be opened in Folio.

CHAPTER 6

On a computer

Folio works with a keyboard and mouse too.

Turn pages
Arrow keys, Space, Page Up and Page Down, or the mouse wheel.

Jump to the ends
Home and End.

Zoom
Ctrl or Cmd with plus, minus, or 0 to fit the page.

Search and bookmarks
Ctrl or Cmd with F to search, B to bookmark, Esc to close a panel.

You are ready

Tap the back arrow at the top left to return to your library and add your own books.

Done with this guide? Remove it from its ... menu in the library. Settings brings the tour back whenever you like.